FRANCISCO CUETO ALAVA

PhD Candidate in Economics | University of Sussex
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RESEARCH FIELDS

Applied Microeconomics; Economics of Crime; Political Economy; Development Economics.
Research themes: crime and institutional trust; political accountability; policy evaluation.

EDUCATION

University of Sussex, United Kingdom 2023–expected 2027
PhD Candidate in Economics | Supervisors: Richard Dickens and Barry Reilly
Planned thesis submission: May–June 2027.

University of Sussex, United Kingdom 2021–2022
MSc in Development Economics (Distinction)

Pontificia Universidad Católica del Perú 2010–2016
BA in Economics

JOB MARKET PAPER

"Designed Nationally, Blamed Locally: Implementation Failure and Trust in Government in Peru." Single-authored; October 2026 draft.

Abstract: When a nationally designed programme fails at the point of local delivery, which tier of government do citizens blame? I exploit a 2015 administrative failure that interrupted Peru's national school feeding programme, Qali Warma, in 22% of districts, where design and financing were national but procurement involved municipalities. Using difference-in-differences on matched districts, I find that trust in the district municipality fell by 5.8–6.4 percentage points (29–32%), while evaluations of the central government and the Ministry of Education were unchanged; electoral data suggest the penalty carried into the next municipal election. Decentralising implementation shifts the political risk of failure onto local governments.

WORKING PAPERS

"Migration Shocks, Institutional Capacity, and the Erosion of Public Trust." Single-authored; October 2026 draft.

"Does Bringing the State Closer Increase Trust in Public Institutions? Evidence from the Tambos Platform in Rural Peru." With Richard Dickens; preliminary manuscript.

PEER-REVIEWED JOURNAL PUBLICATIONS

Cozzubo, A., Amaya, E., & **Cueto, J.** (2021). "The social costs of crime: the erosion of trust between citizens and public institutions." *Economics of Governance*, 22(2), 93–117. doi:10.1007/s10101-021-00251-0

Alvarez, L., Arcaya, G., **Cueto, F.**, & de la Torre, R. (2023). "Can public credit programs improve artisanal fisher performance? The case of FONDEPES a credit program." *Marine Policy*, 156, 105792. doi:10.1016/j.marpol.2023.105792

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

"Can a mining formalization strategy reduce crime in Peru? Evidence from REINFO for the 2010–2019 period." *With Brandon Laureano.*

"Indirect Effects of the JUNTOS Program: Evidence on Infant and Childhood Mortality." *With Guillermo Jopén.*

"Minimum-Wage Increases, Formal Employment and Wages in Peru." *With Viviana Cruzado and Giancarlos Rivera.*

"Community Mental Health Care and Psychological Well-being." *With Elard Amaya.*

SELECTED POLICY RESEARCH

Amaya, E., Cozzubo, A., **Cueto, J.**, & Hernández, W. (2021). "Is hotspot policing effective in Peru? Evidence from Barrio Seguro." Policy report, CIES.

Drucker, A., Ramírez, M., **Cueto, J.**, et al. (2022). "Feed Me Sustainably: Improving the sustainability of public food procurement programmes using threatened crop diversity." *Policy Brief No. 67*, Bioversity International.

Hopkins, A., **Cueto, J.**, & Arcaya, J. (2019). "Design and results evaluation of PROCOMPITE." Evaluation report, PRODUCE, Peru.

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS AND TEACHING

Universidad Peruana de Ciencias Aplicadas (UPC), Peru 2026–present
Research Faculty (Profesor Investigador), Economics
Supervise eight undergraduate research students and coordinate economics research seminars.

University of Sussex, United Kingdom 2025–present
Doctoral Tutor, Economics | Introduction to Economics; Microeconomics I

Universidad Peruana de Ciencias Aplicadas (UPC), Peru 2023–2026
Lecturer, Economics | Behavioural Economics; undergraduate thesis supervision

RESEARCH AND IMPACT EVALUATION EXPERIENCE

London School of Economics and Political Science, United Kingdom 2024–2025
Research Assistant, Department of Management
Contributed to research on randomisation of a microfinance project in East Africa through data processing, literature review, and statistical/econometric analysis.

Youth Endowment Fund (YEF), United Kingdom 2023–2024
Managed three violence-prevention evaluations (Chance UK – My Future and Spark2Life mentoring; focused deterrence), overseeing independent evaluators' protocols, analysis plans and reports.

EARLIER EVALUATION AND POLICY EXPERIENCE · PERU

Ministry of Labour and Employment Promotion · *Consultant (IDB-funded)* 2021
Designed and estimated a difference-in-differences evaluation of minimum-wage changes on employment and earnings.

Ministry of Transport and Communications · *Evaluation Coordinator* 2021
Designed the panel-DiD evaluation of the Subnational Transport Support Programme; drafted the ministry's M&E Directive.

Ministry of Economy and Finance · *Evaluation Consultant (IDB-funded)* 2020–2021
Designed the baseline sample, power calculations, instruments and RCT evaluation of local-government tax systems.

Ministry of Production · *Impact Evaluation Specialist* 2018–2020
Designed samples and surveys for Tu Empresa and PROCOMPITE; managed fieldwork; co-authored the PROCOMPITE report.

Ministry of Development and Social Inclusion · *Social Policy Evaluation Analyst* 2018
Designed impact evaluations of the JUNTOS cash-transfer pilot (PSM + DiD) and Cuna Más (RCT, PSM + DiD).

Ministry of Economy and Finance · *Consultant, Quality of Public Expenditure* 2015–2017
Supported evaluations of EUROPAN, Beca 18 and FONIPREL; co-drafted a multiannual budgeting framework.

SELECTED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS AND WORKSHOPS

2026 Freiburg PhD Workshop on the Economics of Criminal Behavior (Max Planck Institute); RES Annual Conference; RES Job Market Workshop; Southern PhD Economics Conference (Southampton); PhD Conference in Economics (Tor Vergata); PhD Economics Workshop (Sussex).

2025 Royal Economic Society Annual Conference; 18th Workshop on Social Economy for Young Economists (Bologna); III PhD Conference in Social Sciences and Economics (Sapienza University of Rome).

GRANTS, AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

2024, 2023, 2020, 2018 Annual Research Awards (competitive funding), CIES, Peru.

2024 Scholarship, ICID International School on Impact Evaluation of Development Policies.

2023 Beca Generación del Bicentenario (PRONABEC) — doctoral scholarship.

2021 Sussex Chancellor's International and EU Scholarship and Business School International Masters Award.

2016 CEDLAS scholarship for training in public policy impact evaluation.

RESEARCH METHODS, SOFTWARE AND LANGUAGES

Methods Difference-in-differences (including staggered adoption); instrumental variables and shift-share IV; matching and doubly robust estimators; evaluation design, sampling and power calculations; linked survey and administrative data.

Software Stata (advanced); R/RStudio (intermediate). **Languages** Spanish (native); English (fluent).

REFERENCES

Prof. Richard Dickens · Professor of Economics, University of Sussex · R.F.Dickens@sussex.ac.uk

Prof. Barry Reilly · Professor of Econometrics, University of Sussex · B.M.Reilly@sussex.ac.uk

Prof. Andy McKay · Professor of Development Economics, University of Sussex · A.Mckay@sussex.ac.uk

Dr Viviana Cruzado · Director of Design and Methodology, OFIS (Peru) · vcruzado@ofis.gob.pe

Sarah Williams · Evaluation Analyst, DSIT (UK) · sarah.williams@dsit.gov.uk